

	District/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors (SNAP)
	Section No./Name	B-200-SNAP Citizenship/Alien Status (SNAP)
	Document No./Name	B-210-SNAP Eligibility Requirement-Citizenship
	Effective Date	December 15, 2025

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

U.S. CITIZENS AND U.S. NATIONALS ARE ELIGIBLE FOR BENEFITS IF THEY MEET ALL ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA.

A U.S. NATIONAL IS A PERSON BORN IN AMERICAN SAMOA OR THE SWAINS ISLAND. THESE PLACES ARE KNOWN AS OUTLYING POSSESSIONS OF THE UNITED STATES. INDIVIDUALS BORN IN GUAM BETWEEN 1898 AND 1950, IN PUERTO RICO BETWEEN 1898 AND 1917, IN THE US VIRGIN ISLANDS BETWEEN 1917 AND 1927, OR IN THE PHILIPPINES BETWEEN 1898 AND 1946, ARE ALSO CONSIDERED A U.S. NATIONAL BUT NOT A U.S. CITIZEN, UNLESS CITIZENSHIP WAS INHERITED FROM HIS OR HER PARENTS. THERE IS NO REQUIREMENT FOR U.S. NATIONALS TO REGISTER WITH THE U.S. CITIZENSHIP AND IMMIGRATION SERVICES (USCIS) OR CARRY ANY DOCUMENTATION.

B-211-SNAP - PO VERIFICATION

CITIZENSHIP MUST BE VERIFIED FOR ALL INDIVIDUALS IN THE SNAP HOUSEHOLD. IF PROOF OF CITIZENSHIP IS NOT PROVIDED FOR ONE HOUSEHOLD MEMBER, THEY WILL BE DISQUALIFIED AND THE REMAINING HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS MAY BE CERTIFIED.

Before receiving proof, unless expedited, treat the person as disqualified. Count all his resources and all but his pro rata share of income as available to the household.

CITIZENSHIP VERIFICATION FOR FITAP/KCSP OR SNAP IS USED FOR BOTH PROGRAMS.

B-212-SNAP - PO DOCUMENTS TO VERIFY CITIZENSHIP

OBTAIN THE FOLLOWING:

BIRTH CERTIFICATE, HOSPITAL CERTIFICATE OR U.S. PASSPORT, OR UNITED STATES CITIZENSHIP AND IMMIGRATION SERVICES (USCIS) CERTIFICATE OF CITIZENSHIP OR NATURALIZATION.

IF THE CLIENT CANNOT PROVIDE ANY DOCUMENTARY EVIDENCE, THE FOLLOWING SOURCES MUST BE USED:

- THE PATERNITY ESTABLISHMENT AND SUPPORT ENFORCEMENT (PESE) INTERFACE IF THE INDIVIDUAL WAS BORN IN LOUISIANA OR
- THE SYSTEMATIC ALIEN VERIFICATION FOR ENTITLEMENTS (SAVE) PROGRAM.

IF THE INDIVIDUAL'S CITIZENSHIP CANNOT BE VERIFIED BY ANY OF THE FORMENTIONED SOURCES, A THIRD-PARTY AFFIDAVIT OF U.S. CITIZENSHIP OR U.S. NATIONALITY FORM

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(SNAP 39) IS REQUIRED. THE AFFIDAVIT MUST VERIFY THAT:

- THE AFFIANT IS A U.S. CITIZEN,
- THE AFFIANT KNOWS THAT THE APPLICANT IS A U.S. CITIZEN, OR A U.S. NATIONAL,
- THE AFFIANT MAY BE FINED, IMPRISONED, OR BOTH IF HE GIVES FALSE INFORMATION.

ADVISE THAT THE AFFIDAVIT IS A SWORN STATEMENT AND THAT THE AFFIANT SHOULD CERTIFY ONLY THOSE FACTS OF WHICH THEY HAVE PERSONAL KNOWLEDGE.

B-213-SNAP - PO DOCUMENTATION

DOCUMENT HOW CITIZENSHIP WAS VERIFIED AND THE REASON FOR EXCLUDING A PERSON.

II. PROCEDURES

B-211-SNAP – PR VERIFICATION

REVIEW VERIFICATION DOCUMENTS PROVIDED OR RESULTS OF ALTERNATIVE VERIFICATION SOURCES (PESE OR SAVE).

B-212-SNAP – PR DOCUMENTS TO VERIFY CITIZENSHIP

AFTER RECEIVING DOCUMENTS PROVIDED OR RESULTS OBTAINED FROM ALTERNATIVE VERIFICATION SOURCES, REVIEW THE DOCUMENTS AND INFORMATION TO DETERMINE IF THE INDIVIDUAL IS A CITIZEN OF THE UNITED STATES OR A U.S. NATIONAL.

PESE CAN BE ACCESSED IN LITE BY THE FOLLOWING METHODS:

- THE PESE ON-DEMAND BUTTON FROM THE 'INTERNAL LINKS' LEFT NAVIGATION PANEL ON THE LITE HOME SCREEN OR
- THE PESE ON-DEMAND BUTTONS DISPLAYED ON THE FOLLOWING SCREENS WITHIN DATA COLLECTION IN LITE FROM THE 'CASE INFO' RIGHT NAVIGATION PANEL:
 - PERSON - DETAILS,
 - RELATIONSHIP - DETAILS, AND
 - PERSON DEMOGRAPHICS – DETAILS.

TO VERIFY U. S. CITIZENSHIP THROUGH SAVE, A CASE RELATED HELP DESK TICKET MUST BE SUBMITTED THROUGH THE OTS USER SUPPORT CENTER REMEDY INTRANET TICKET GENERATOR (IVANTI). SELECT 'ENTER INCIDENT' AND INCLUDE THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION:

- PLEASE VERIFY CITIZENSHIP THROUGH SAVE

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- LAST NAME
- FIRST NAME
- DATE OF BIRTH
- SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER (SSN)

THE DOCUMENTARY EVIDENCE EITHER RECEIVED FROM THE HOUSEHOLD OR VERIFIED THROUGH ALTERNATIVE SOURCES MUST BE FILED IN THE DOCUMENT RESPOSITORY SYSTEM AND INDEXED AS A PERMANENT DOCUMENT FOR THE INDIVIDUAL AND CASE.

B-213-SNAP – PR DOCUMENTATION

STAFF MUST DOCUMENT U.S. CITIZENSHIP, U.S. NATIONAL, OR NON-CITIZEN (ALIEN) STATUS FOR EACH INDIVIDUAL IN THE HOUSEHOLD.

NAVIGATE TO THE PERSON DEMOGRAPHICS – DETAILS SCREEN IN LITE, AND ANSWER THE CITIZENSHIP QUESTION AS FOLLOWS:

- SELECT U.S. CITIZEN, IF THE HOUSEHOLD MEMBER IS A U.S. CITIZEN.
- SELECT U.S. NATIONAL, IF THE HOUSEHOLD MEMBER IS A U.S. NATIONAL.
- SELECT ALIEN, IF THE HOUSEHOLD MEMBER IS A NON-CITIZEN. WHEN ALIEN IS SELECTED, THE ALIEN DETAILS SCREEN WILL DISPLAY. COMPLETE THE APPLICABLE FIELDS ON THE SCREEN.

IF VERIFICATION OF CITIZENSHIP IS NOT AVAILABLE, SELECT PENDING VERIFICATION IN THE CITIZENSHIP VERIFICATION FIELD. IF VERIFICATION OF CITIZENSHIP IS NOT PROVIDED OR CAN NOT BE VERIFIED THROUGH THE ALTERNATIVE SOURCES, THE HOUSEHOLD MEMBER WILL BE DISQUALIFIED FOR 'FAILURE TO ATTEST TO CITIZENSHIP'.

DOCUMENT IN A CASE NOTE HOW CITIZENSHIP WAS VERIFIED AND THE REASON FOR EXCLUDING A PERSON.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

SNAP 39 [Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Third-Party Affidavit of U.S. Citizenship of U.S. Nationality

IV. REFERENCES

Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program Guidance on Non-Citizen Eligibility June 2011
[7 CFR 273.4](#)
[LA HB 307- Act No. 351](#)